2. A wide network of Voluntary Consumer Organisation (VCO) is doing commendable work to raise awareness amongst consumers.
3. To strengthen consumer protection and welfare and to provide counselling, guidance and mediation services.
4. VCO's supported through CWF provides grants for diverse projects including comparative testing of products and services and dissemination of the findings
5. Steps have been taken to enhance transparency and to digitalise the government's interface with its citizens.

## Accelerating Consumer Awareness/Educating Consumers

The first priority of a consumer organization is to accelerate consumer awareness towards their rights. To accomplish this task the following efforts are made:

i. To publish brochures journals and monographs.
ii. To arrange conferences, seminars and workshops.
iii. To educate consumers to help themselves.
iv. To provide special education to women about consumerism.

To maintain desirable standards, the following steps are followed:

### i) Collecting Data on Different Products and testing them

These organizations collect samples of different products from time to time and test them. After that the results of the tests are declared to public. In this way, these organisations provide prior information to consumers about the authenticity of product and protect them.

### ii) Filing Suit on Behalf of Consumers

Whenever a consumer fails to raise his voice of protest regarding his complaints, these consumers' organisations come to the rescue and file a case in the court, on behalf of a consumer. By giving this service to the consumers, the consumers get a feeling that they are not alone in their struggle.

### iii) Organising Protests against Adulteration etc.

The consumer's organizations play a significant role in eliminating the evil of adulteration, hoarding black-marketing and under-weight selling.

### iv) Helping Educational Institutions

These organizations advice the educational institutions the way to prepare courses of study keeping in view the interests of the consumers.

### v) Promoting Network of Consumer Association

Consumer organizations are trying to grow their numbers. They want to cover all the regions of the country so that consumers of all the regions are benefited by their services.

### vi) Extending Support to Government

Consumer organisations keep informing the government agencies about adulteration, artificial scarcity, inferior quality produce etc. to help the government.

## Procedures for Filing Complaint

A complaint can be filed by a complainant against the seller, manufacturer, or dealer of goods which are defective or against the provider of services, if they are deficient in any manner whatsoever. An unfair trade practice or restrictive trade practice can also invite complaint

## Steps involved in filing Complaint in Consumer Court

The first step in filing a consumer complaint is to send a legal notice to the seller or company. A legal notice must be drafted with the help of a consumer court lawyer and include the following:



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